

Science Corps Fellowship Application

Thank you for your interest in becoming a Science Corps Fellow. Please complete all required fields. We review applications on a rolling basis.

First Name *

Rachel

Last Name *

Meister

Email *

rachelmeistercl@gmail.com

Gender

☐

Male

☒

Female

☐

Non-Binary

Residence: City (State), Country *

Glattbrugg (Zurich), Switzerland

Nationality *

New Zealand / Swiss

When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD? (month and year) *

December, 2026

Please indicate the university where you earned (or are currently pursuing) your PhD *

University of Zurich, Switzerland

Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow? *

After my PhD, I would like to stay connected to science while engaging more directly with society. Research ultimately serves a public purpose, and I am motivated by the chance to extend that purpose into direct work with students. I believe in knowledge as a common good: it empowers learners, expands choices and opens doors. I did not grow up with scientists in my family and was not aware for a long time that research could be a realistic career path. It would thus be particularly meaningful for me to help students see science not as something distant or reserved for a few people, but as an accessible way of asking questions, solving problems and understanding the world.

Having spent my entire academic journey at one place, I am now looking for opportunities to gain experience in a different environment and expand my horizons. Working abroad and contributing to science education in a new context would allow me to grow both professionally and personally.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science *
Corps Fellow.

During my PhD, I taught biochemistry to undergraduate students and supervised practical lab work. I enjoyed breaking complex ideas into approachable steps and seeing students' understanding grow. Motivated by this, I completed a teaching course covering pedagogical methods such as conceptual change, inquiry-based learning and backward design.

I also mentored a master's student for one year. This required a more individual approach, as I had to adapt my feedback style, discuss expectations and motivate during failures. It taught me that good teaching depends not only on clear explanations but also on responding to the learner.

Beyond university teaching, my work as an English proofreader for a school institution has provided insight into curriculum implementation, differentiated learning and school life. Lastly, my experience immigrating to Switzerland at age 10 without German shaped my communication, making me attentive to context, body language and different ways of understanding.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply. *

- ☒ Scientist in academia
- ☐ Doing science in industry
- ☐ Administrative role in industry or academia
- ☒ In science education
- ☒ In science outreach
- ☐ Other:

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally *
in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

In the near future, I imagine myself in a purposefully exploratory phase of my career. After completing my PhD and becoming highly specialised in brain energy metabolism, my short-term goal is to broaden my perspective and apply my scientific training in settings beyond a research laboratory. The Science Corps Fellowship is an ideal starting point for this next stage. It would allow me to use the analytical, organisational and communication skills I developed during my PhD while gaining direct experience in science education, curriculum development and outreach.

After the fellowship, I could see myself taking on an academic postdoctoral position as a way to continue developing as an independent scientist. A postdoctoral role would allow me to explore new research questions, learn new techniques, and take on greater responsibility in project planning, collaboration, mentoring, and resource management. At the same time, having experienced both an academic environment and a science education/outreach setting would help me clarify my long-term priorities and identify where I can contribute most meaningfully.

Looking toward the long-term future, I hope to remain connected to science without necessarily following the traditional academic route. Science communication roles are of high interest to me, whether in education, public outreach, curriculum development, or training scientists to communicate their work more effectively. I believe there is often a gap between the scientific community and the general public, not only in terms of knowledge but also in terms of trust, expectations, and understanding of how research works. I would find it very rewarding to contribute to narrowing that gap.

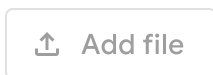
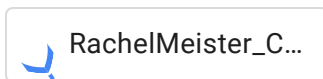
Alongside this, I have a strong interest in leadership and people-centred work. Through courses in leadership and management, as well as my own professional experience, I have come to value the importance of supportive working environments, clear communication, and constructive professional relationships. In the long term, I would like to take on roles where I can help build effective teams, improve systems, and create conditions in which people can do high-quality work.

Whether in science education, outreach or another science-related field, I hope to combine my scientific background with communication, leadership, and a commitment to making science more accessible.

How did you find out about Science Corps? *

- ☒ An email list in your institution
- ☐ A post on a job-site
- ☐ An entry in a post-doc search resource (e.g., ecoevjobs.net)
- ☐ Referred by a previous fellow
- ☐ Referred by a friend/colleague/supervisor in academia
- ☐ Other:

Upload your CV / resume *



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